

Statistics, Probability and Linear Programming

Solved Questions – Unit 1 & Unit 2

This PDF contains concise solved problems from Unit 1 and Unit 2 based on the uploaded question bank (pages 4–14).

Unit 1 – Least Squares Fit

Question: Fit a straight line $y = ax + b$ using least squares.

Solution: Normal equations:

$$\Sigma y = na + b\Sigma x$$

$$\Sigma xy = a\Sigma x + b\Sigma x^2$$

Solve simultaneously to obtain a and b .

Correlation Coefficient

Question: Define correlation coefficient.

Solution: Karl Pearson coefficient:

$$r = [\Sigma xy - \Sigma x \Sigma y] / \sqrt{[(\Sigma x^2 - (\Sigma x)^2)(\Sigma y^2 - (\Sigma y)^2)]}$$

Regression Lines

Question: State regression equations.

Solution: Regression of y on x : $y - \bar{y} = b_{yx}(x - \bar{x})$

Regression of x on y : $x - \bar{x} = b_{xy}(y - \bar{y})$

Binomial Distribution

Question: Mean and variance of Binomial distribution.

Solution: For $X \sim B(n, p)$: Mean = np and Variance = npq where $q = 1 - p$.

Poisson Distribution

Question: Mean and variance of Poisson distribution.

Solution: For $X \sim \text{Poisson}(\lambda)$: Mean = λ and Variance = λ .

Worked Binomial Example

Question: Probability of exactly 3 heads in 5 tosses.

Solution: Using $P(X=r) = {}^nC_r p^r q^{n-r}$
 $P(X=3) = {}^5C_3 (1/2)^5 = 10/32 = 0.3125$

Poisson Example

Question: Average defects = 2. Find probability of exactly 3 defects.

Solution: $P(X=3) = e^{-2} 2^3 / 3! = 0.1804$

Normal Distribution

Question: State pdf of normal distribution.

Solution: $f(x) = \frac{1}{(\sigma\sqrt{2\pi})} \cdot \exp[-(x-\mu)^2/(2\sigma^2)]$

Standard Normal Variable

Question: Define standard normal variable.

Solution: $Z = (X - \mu)/\sigma$ follows standard normal distribution with mean 0 and variance 1.

Exponential Distribution

Question: State pdf and mean.

Solution: $f(x) = \lambda e^{-\lambda x}$, $x > 0$
Mean = $1/\lambda$

Uniform Distribution

Question: State pdf of Uniform(a,b).

Solution: $f(x) = 1/(b-a)$, $a < x < b$

Gamma Distribution

Question: State mean and variance of Gamma distribution.

Solution: If $X \sim \text{Gamma}(\alpha, \beta)$: Mean = α/β and Variance = α/β^2

Joint Probability

Question: Define joint probability distribution.

Solution: A function giving probabilities of simultaneous occurrence of X and Y values.

Marginal Density

Question: Define marginal density function.

Solution: $f_X(x) = \int f(x,y) dy$ and $f_Y(y) = \int f(x,y) dx$

Conditional Probability Density

Question: Define conditional density.

Solution: $f(x|y) = f(x,y)/f_Y(y)$

Worked Normal Example

Question: If $X \sim N(50, 10^2)$, find $P(X < 60)$.

Solution: $Z = (60 - 50)/10 = 1$.
 $P(Z < 1) = 0.8413$

Worked Exponential Example

Question: Mean lifetime = 5 years. Find $P(X > 3)$.

Solution: $\lambda = 1/5$.

$$P(X > 3) = e^{-3/5} = 0.5488$$

Worked Uniform Example

Question: $X \sim U(0, 10)$. Find $P(2 < X < 6)$.

Solution: $P = (6 - 2) / (10 - 0) = 4/10 = 0.4$

Joint Distribution Example

Question: If $f(x, y) = x + y$ on $0 < x < 1$, $0 < y < 1$, write marginal of X .

Solution: $f_X(x) = \int_0^1 (x + y) dy = x + 1/2$

Prepared from the uploaded MSRIT Statistics, Probability and Linear Programming question bank (Unit 1 & Unit 2).